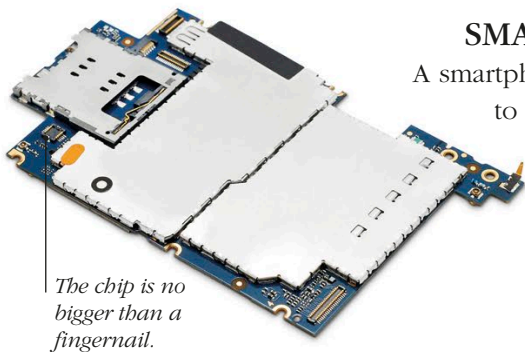




SMARTPHONE COMPUTER

A smartphone is powered by a chip. Not to be confused with the SIM card, which communicates with external networks, a chip is a small computer processor that makes all the phone's many features work.

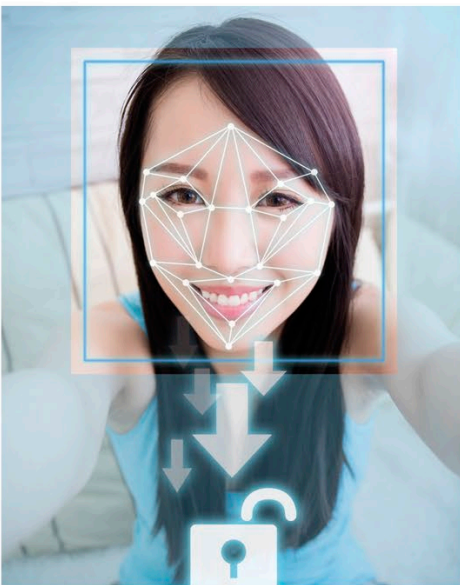
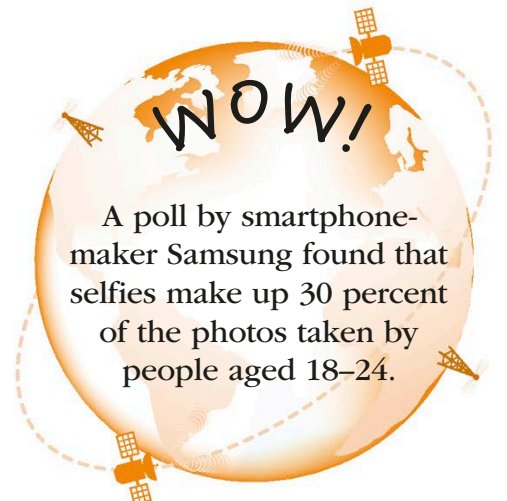
SAY CHEESE

Historically, self-portraits were only painted by artists or taken by cameras set on a timer. Thanks to innovations such as the smartphone's front-facing camera and selfie sticks we have all gone selfie crazy.



EMOJIS

The earliest emojis were designed in 1998 by Shigetaka Kurita, an employee of a Japanese cell phone carrier. They convey complex information about human emotions in a single character.



SMART TECH

In the race to entice consumers, smartphones have become thinner, faster, and, well, smarter. New, clever technology includes use of the camera as a scanner, for instance, to translate foreign text on a menu.

◀ FACIAL RECOGNITION

Several phones have facial recognition as a security device to unlock a phone's screen. Some identify patterns in the iris of the eye, others use infrared to scan the whole face.

▼ FINGERTIP SCAN

A smartphone with a fingerprint scanner appeared in 2007 but the technology became widespread with the iPhone 5S in 2013.

